

The Airbnb & STR Setup Checklist

Everything that goes into a short-term rental that photographs beautifully, books consistently, and earns five-star reviews — from planning the space to the day you go live. Print it, work through it, and check off as you go.

01 Plan the Space First

- ☐ Define your **ideal guest** and target nightly rate
- ☐ Set a **maximum occupancy** and design to it
- ☐ Measure every room; plan layout, flow, and sightlines
- ☐ Maximize comfortable sleeping without overcrowding
- ☐ Choose one **cohesive style & palette** that photographs well
- ☐ Plan for durability — this is a working rental, not a home

02 Furnish for Durability & Photos

- ☐ Sofa & seating in **performance fabric**
- ☐ Quality **mattresses** — the #1 driver of reviews
- ☐ Dining seating for full occupancy
- ☐ Rugs, side tables, and lamps in every key room
- ☐ Art & wall decor at the right scale for photos
- ☐ Window treatments for light control & privacy
- ☐ Layered, warm lighting (2700K) with a statement piece
- ☐ Accessories & styling — the layer that sells the photo

03 Stock the Kitchen

- ☐ Cookware, bakeware, and a good knife set
- ☐ Dishes, glasses, mugs & utensils for occupancy +2
- ☐ Coffee maker + supplies, kettle, toaster
- ☐ Pantry basics: oil, salt & pepper, foil, wrap
- ☐ Dish soap, dishwasher pods, sponges, towels
- ☐ Trash bins + liners in every needed room

04 Bed & Bath: Hotel-Level Comfort

- ☐ **Two sets** of quality linens per bed
- ☐ Extra pillows, blankets, and a throw per bed
- ☐ Bath towels (2+ per guest), hand towels, bath mats
- ☐ Shampoo, conditioner, body wash, hand soap
- ☐ Hair dryer, and a stocked supply of toilet paper
- ☐ Iron, plunger, and a small first-aid kit

05 Amenities That Earn 5 Stars

- ☐ Fast, reliable **Wi-Fi** — post the network & password
- ☐ Smart TV with streaming
- ☐ Coffee & tea station
- ☐ A workspace or desk nook
- ☐ Heat, AC, fans, and extra layers for any season
- ☐ Furnished, tidy outdoor space
- ☐ Welcome binder / local guide, and a small welcome gift

06 Safety & Compliance

- ☐ **Smoke & CO detectors** installed and tested
- ☐ Fire extinguisher and clearly posted exits
- ☐ Secure locks / smart lock; exterior lighting
- ☐ House rules & emergency info posted
- ☐ Check local **STR permit / registration** & lodging tax
- ☐ Short-term-rental insurance in place

07 Run It Smoothly

- ☐ A reliable cleaner & a written turnover checklist
- ☐ A restock system for consumables
- ☐ Pricing & calendar tool
- ☐ Saved guest-message templates
- ☐ Noise / occupancy monitoring where appropriate

08 Before You List

- ☐ **Professional photos** — staged & styled
- ☐ A compelling title and honest, vivid description
- ☐ Complete, accurate amenities list
- ☐ Competitive pricing researched for your area
- ☐ A friendly walkthrough / final quality check

Want it designed & done for you?

Drift designs short-term rentals end to end — layout, furnishing, styling, and the guest-experience details — so your rental is ready to book. drift-ia.com/airbnb

Ready for the full playbook? Our complete **Airbnb & STR Design Guide** is available on Etsy.